MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD & Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including 2+ years building CI/CD infrastructure, Kubernetes-based test environments, and developer tooling. Hands-on experience creating Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster, improving pipeline performance, and developing tooling with Python and Bash. Personal experience with a k3s homelab, GitOps, monitoring and Terraform-based provisioning. Preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam; exam booked for January 2027; seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Argo CD, Terraform (personal Hetzner project), Ansible (basic)

Monitoring & observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; test metrics dashboards

Programming & scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Systems & data: Linux, Git, PostgreSQL

Cloud learning: AWS basics (EC2, S3; personal learning only)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for 3 product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing into its own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments with GitLab CI and Helm, deploying the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data to namespaces on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. QA and product teams use the environments to review features before merge. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built Python and Bash tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data.
- Created a PostgreSQL-backed test results workflow and Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.
- Wrote an internal guide to the CI system used in onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform in a personal account.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Automated short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments with seeded data, deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against each environment.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled CI pipelines for three teams; parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- The flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the leading offenders.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | Studying; exam booked for January 2027
Terraform Associate | Practice tests completed; exam not taken

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)